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CREW · OX-CRW-001

Crew Employment & Welfare Policy

Recruitment, contracts, hours of rest, wellbeing and repatriation for seafarers (MLC 2006)

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Policy owner	Capt. Maria Santos-Reyes, Head of Crew Management (OceanX Ship Management, fictional)	**Approved by**	Capt. Henrik Vestergaard, Chief Operating Officer
Applies to	All seafarers serving on OceanX-owned and managed vessels, including those supplied by manning agencies	**Classification**	Public

1. Commitment

OceanX employs about **6,200 seafarers** from more than 20 nationalities. We comply with the **Maritime Labour Convention 2006 (as amended)**, STCW 2010 (Manila Amendments) and applicable collective bargaining agreements (ITF-approved CBAs). Every seafarer has the right to a safe workplace, fair terms of employment, decent living conditions, health protection and welfare.

2. Recruitment and manning agencies

- OceanX recruits directly through crewing offices in **Manila (Philippines)**, **Mumbai (India)**, **Constanta (Romania)** and **Shanghai (China)**.
- Third-party manning agencies must be licensed and certified under MLC Regulation 1.4 and audited annually by OceanX.
- **No recruitment fees** are charged to seafarers, either directly or indirectly.
- Every candidate needs a valid STCW certificate of competency, a flag-state endorsement, an ENG1 or equivalent medical certificate, and a seafarer's identity document.

3. Seafarer Employment Agreement (SEA)

Each seafarer receives a signed SEA in a language they understand, with at least 7 days to review it before signing. The SEA covers:

Term	Standard
Contract length	Officers 4 months; ratings 6 months (maximum 11 months on board under MLC)
Basic working hours	8 hours per day, 40 hours per week, plus guaranteed overtime per CBA
Paid leave	Minimum 2.5 days per month of service (MLC); OceanX standard is 8 days per month for officers
Wages	Paid monthly by bank transfer; allotment to family accounts available at no cost
Wage statement	Monthly, itemised, in USD and the home currency

4. Hours of work and rest

Minimum rest is **10 hours in any 24-hour period** and **77 hours in any 7-day period**. Rest may be split into no more than two periods, one of which must be at least 6 hours. Records are kept in the electronic Hours of Rest system and checked monthly by Fleet Superintendents. Any falsification of records is gross misconduct.

5. Crew change and repatriation

- Repatriation is at **OceanX's cost** at the end of contract, in case of illness or injury, shipwreck, or vessel sale or change of flag.
- Seafarers may not be kept on board beyond 11 months. A crew change is planned at the latest 30 days before the contract ends.
- Financial security for repatriation and abandonment is in place under MLC Standard A2.5.2 (P&I Club certificate posted on board).

6. Health, medical care and welfare

- Free medical care on board and ashore while serving. Every vessel has 24/7 telemedical support through OceanX MedLink (fictional provider).
- Sick pay at full basic wage for up to 16 weeks after repatriation.
- Shipowner liability for death or long-term disability, as set out in the CBA.
- Free on-board Wi-Fi of at least 2 GB per person per week, satellite TV and a gym on all vessels over 5,000 TEU.
- A mental health and wellbeing helpline (24/7, multilingual) is provided by an independent counselling provider.
- Shore leave is encouraged whenever port and security conditions allow.

7. Accommodation and food

Cabins meet MLC Title 3 standards (single-berth cabins for all crew on ships built after 2013). Food and drinking water are provided free of charge, in good quality and quantity, and respect religious and cultural needs. The Master inspects the galley and provision stores weekly.

8. Drug and alcohol policy

- Zero alcohol on board during sea passage. In port, a limit of 0.05% BAC applies when off duty, and 0.00% for watchkeepers.
- Unannounced testing at least once a year per vessel, plus pre-joining, post-incident and for-cause testing.
- A positive test leads to removal from duty, investigation and, normally, termination.

9. Conduct, discipline and complaints

- On-board complaints follow MLC Regulation 5.1.5: first to the Head of Department, then to the Master, then to the shore-based Crew Welfare Officer. Contact details are posted in every mess room.
- Seafarers may complain directly to the flag state or port state at any time without retaliation.
- Harassment, bullying and violence are prohibited (in line with ILO/ICS Guidance on harassment and bullying, 2016).

10. Training and career development

- Mandatory STCW refreshers, plus OceanX-specific courses: LNG dual-fuel operations, cyber awareness, Bridge Resource Management, and leadership for junior officers.
- A cadet programme takes 120 cadets per year, with guaranteed officer employment on graduation.
- Promotion is based on appraisal at each sign-off, competence assessment and sea time.

11. Contacts

Crew Welfare Officer (24/7): +63 2 5555 0177 (Manila) | crewwelfare@oceanxlogistics.example

OceanX Logistics is a fictional company created for AI training and demonstration. All names, addresses, vessels, registration numbers and figures are invented.